ASSETS · TRADING

What a price is

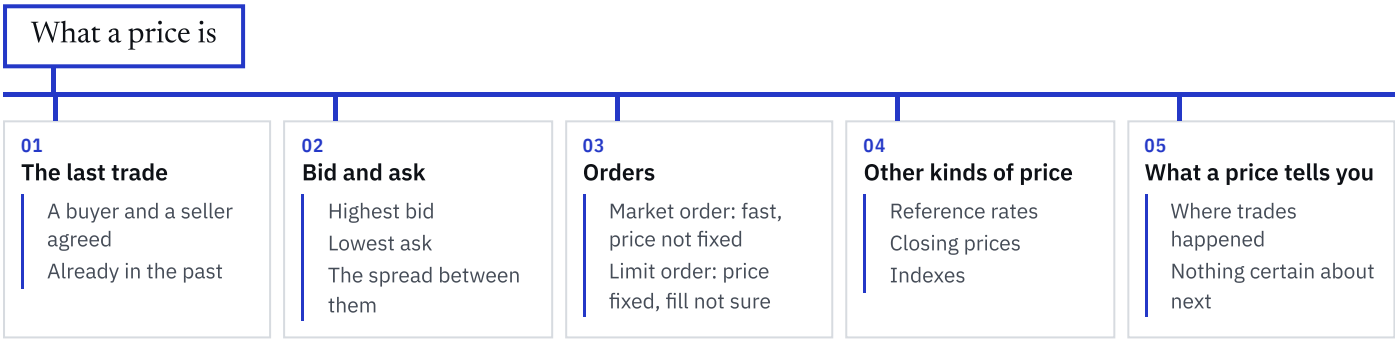
Where a market price comes from and what it tells you.

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What you will learn

The price you see on a screen is usually the last trade: the most recent moment a buyer and a seller agreed. Behind it sit two other numbers, the highest price someone is bidding and the lowest price someone is asking, and the gap between them. This piece explains where a market price comes from, why the price you get can differ from the one you saw, and how some prices are set another way, like the daily reference rates a central bank publishes. Education only: nothing here tells you what to buy or sell.

Map of the piece



Sources

1 **Types of Orders**
U.S. SEC, Investor.gov, 2026
investor.gov

2 **Euro foreign exchange reference rates**
European Central Bank, 2026
ecb.europa.eu

Each source was opened and checked on 14 October 2026. The finished piece may add more.